EQALISER

THE MERCEDES-BENZ EQA HAS ARRIVED IN INDIA AND IT IS ESSENTIALLY THE GLA WITH AN ELECTRIC POWERTRAIN

BY RAHUL GHOSH

Mercedes-Benz has launched the EQA which comes in as the company's entry-level EV, slotting in below the EQB.

The EQA is a derivative of the GLA and hence the design looks similar. However, being electric, it gets its own set of design highlights. The grille is unique and gets intricate details along with the large Mercedes-Benz logo. The EQA also gets the company's high-performance LED light package. In profile, one can spot the new 19-inch 10-spoke AMG alloys and a generous ground clearance of over 200mm. At the back, the EQA looks even better thanks to the connected tail light unit and a bit of chrome embellishment. The EQA is the first model from Mercedes-EQ whose aerodynamic development has been undertaken entirely digitally.

Inside, the instrument panel consists of a large 10.25-inch digital customisable display. The rest of the dash looks good with a large 10.25-inch infotainment touchscreen with rich graphics. The EQA comes with a premium 12-speaker Burmester audio system, which offers rich audio quality. It gets a head-up display and there's a 360-degree camera view, adaptive high beam assist and active braking assist to aid driving. On the centre console, we like the minimal use of buttons. The toggles provide a crisp feel. The panoramic sunroof is also something that is a highlight. When it comes to space, there is plenty within the cabin. The flat floor adds to the SUV's comfort level. The boot offers 340 litres of space and the rear seats can be folded to increase cargo capacity.

Mercedes-Benz EQA 250
Motor: Single, FWD
Power: 190bhp
Transmission: Single-speed
Range: 560km (WLTP)
Price: ₹66 lakh (ex-showroom)
On sale now

The EQA offered in India comes with a 70.5kWh battery pack which sends power to an electric motor that churns out 190bhp and 385Nm. It has a top speed of 160kmph and a zero to 100kmph time of 8.6 seconds. The EQA has a claimed range of up to 560km (WLTP cycle) and the batteries can be charged up from 10 to 80 per cent in 35 minutes using a 100kW DC fast charger. Using an 11kW AC charger, 0 to 100 per cent takes 7.15 hours, claims Merc.

The EQA is endowed with multiple drive modes and each one of them has its very own characteristics. The steering also feels extremely light and taking three-point turns is rather easy. When it comes to feedback, the unit offers good feedback which helps to enjoy a spirited drive. Body roll is well controlled and around corners the EQA feels confident. It also absorbs bumps well and in all the EQA takes a best of both worlds approach striking a good balance between comfort and sportiness. ■



MERCEDES-BENZ EQA